



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Harvest Academy
School Website: <http://harvest-academy.com>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Harvest Academy NC 27455 presents a clearly classical-leaning program within a Christian, University-Model framework. The school foregrounds a Christian worldview, a traditional Trivium-aligned curriculum, a parental-partnership model, and a commitment to formation of character and virtue alongside intellectual development. Public materials emphasize a three-stage Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Western canon through select middle-school literature, and a heavy role for families as co-educators. This places Harvest Academy solidly in the Classical camp for Curriculum and Pedagogy, with strong Religious/Metaphysical foundations and a robust Parents & Community orientation. However, the site is comparatively thin in making explicit the full range of Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy and certain liturgical practices that some classical schools highlight. Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (with strong CLASSICAL tendencies in core areas and explicit Christian formation), driven by a demonstrable commitment to formation, the Trivium, Great Books, parent partnership, and a University-Model integration of home and school.

Key strengths - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Explicit Christian worldview; Statement of Faith and biblical worldview framing all disciplines; head-of-school articulation of faith as central to schooling. - Curriculum: Clear Trivium framing (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and a strong emphasis on Great Books/history through specific middle-school reading lists; explicit articulation of a liberal-arts core within a Christian framework. - Pedagogy within a Classical frame: University-Model structure blends on-site and home-based learning in service of a formation-oriented approach; emphasis on memory work and classic texts in certain grade bands; a language of "formation" and "virtue." - Parents & Community: Strong partnership with families; explicit parent training and co-teaching expectations; opportunities for parent information nights and church/community integration.

Key growth areas (needle-moving opportunities) - Pedagogy specificity: The public materials could more explicitly document Socratic seminars, disciplined dialogue, and regular memory-work or chant (Schol ) practices at multiple grade levels, as used by some classical schools. The current materials emphasize the University-Model and a classical framework but are less explicit about ongoing Socratic/recitation traditions beyond the Trivium outline. - Liturgical/communal practices: While there are explicit faith-based elements, more explicit references to liturgy, communal worship rhythms, and sacred practices would align even more closely with the Six Essential Elements' liturgical-practices indicators.

Abstracted ranking across categories (based on public materials and the classical rubric) - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Aggregate assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Harvest Academy frames education within a Christian worldview, with explicit statements about biblical worldview and faith life integrated into schooling. The Head of School emphasizes that God's plan for children is to grow academically while experiencing His Spirit through fellowship, signaling transcendental, moral-realist aims in education. - Public materials reference a Statement of Faith and Christian worldview as central to the school's mission, and site sections describe faith-informed formation across the curriculum. - The Parent Partnership materials articulate integration of classical education principles with a Christian worldview, reinforcing a theologically grounded educational frame.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: theology, Christian worldview, biblical worldview, faith life, disciples of Jesus Christ, God, Jesus Christ, worship language (implicit liturgical cadence). These align with Positive Keywords like theology, sacred tradition, Logos, and Christian worldview in the lexicon. - Negative keywords present: none of the explicit secular-relativist indicators; the site avoids "values-neutral" or secular ethics language in favor of explicit Christian formation. This supports a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Why this rating - The school's self-description consistently anchors education in a transcendent, theologically grounded frame (biblical worldview and Statement of Faith) and communal spiritual life, which matches the Positive Keywords for a religiously anchored classical school. The explicit articulation of faith-integrated formation plus "wisdom/virtue" through a Christian lens justifies CLASSICAL.

Citations - Christian worldview and faith life integration: - Head of School faith/formation emphasis: - Parent Partnership alignment with Christian worldview:

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents formation and virtue as central, citing a classical/Christian framework designed to form students in character and wisdom rather than merely pursuing job-readiness, with references to forming disciples and living a biblical worldview. The Lower School language emphasizes forming hearts and minds in a Christian context; the overall mission centers on formation and human flourishing rather than purely vocational outcomes. - The University-Model approach foregrounds partnership with families to maintain a coherent, virtuous education anchored in Christian principles, implying formation as the telos of education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, character, wisdom, human flourishing, moral imagination, love of learning, sacred tradition, Christian worldview, disciples (all align with Positive Keywords like formation, virtue, and teleology in the lexicon). - Negative keywords present: explicit emphasis on "workforce preparation" or "career readiness" is not central; the site does not foreground 21st-century job-readiness as the primary goal. This supports CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The site consistently communicates formation of virtue and wisdom as the primary telos, with explicit emphasis on character and moral formation within a classical framework, aligning with the Positive Keywords for Element 2 and the absence of contrary signals.

Citations - Formation emphasis and virtuous aims: - Formation within the University-Model/Christian worldview:

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is explicitly framed around the Trivium: Grammar stage, Logic stage, and Rhetoric stage, with details about how each stage develops language, critical thinking, and persuasive communication. This is a hallmark of classical curricula. - Great Books / historical engagement appears in Middle School reading selections (e.g., *The Hobbit*, *The Jungle Book*, *The Call of the Wild*, etc.), illustrating an integrated approach to history, literature, and moral/philosophical inquiry. - Specific curricular elements like Saxon Math, All About Reading, IEW Grammar and Writing, and Story of the World indicate a structured, liberal-arts-inflected program that aligns with classical preferences for a broad, rigorous foundation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, liberal arts, history integrated across the curriculum, Story of the World, primary sources, classical canon, Western civilization, and the use of a biblically grounded Christian framework. These map to Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements lexicon (Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Interdisciplinary/harmony; Integration and Wonder; Western canon). - Negative keywords present: there is no strong signal of “social studies” rebranding or a heavy emphasis on project-based learning replacing history; the site emphasizes Great Books and liberal-arts content rather than a purely skills-based approach.

Why this rating - The curriculum centers on the Trivium and classical canon (Great Books) and integrates history/literature/philosophy with a biblically-based framework, which aligns with CLASSICAL criteria. Evidence of a liberal-arts approach and historical engagement supports CLASSICAL.

Citations - Trivium framing and grades: - Great Books / specific literature selections: - Liberal-arts foundations and integration:

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Harvest Academy explicitly describes a University-Model structure that blends on-site instruction with home-based learning, emphasizing parental involvement and a Teacher-parent partnership. This aligns with a classical formation approach, but it is not a fully spelled-out articulation of standard classical pedagogy such as regular Socratic seminars or scholé days in public materials. - Pedagogical emphasis on a three-stage Trivium is described, and upper grades are described as including rhetoric and persuasive communication; lower grades emphasize memory and foundational knowledge. However, specific, repeated references to Socratic seminars, disciplined dialogue, or chant/memory-based recitation beyond standard grammar/logic/rhetoric structure are not explicitly documented in the public text provided. - Some content mentions “great books” and critical reading, as well as a home-school partnership model, which can support classic pedagogy, but the public materials do not consistently spell out step-by-step use of Socratic/Harkness-style discourse or standard memory-work recitation across all levels.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, great conversation, memory work, recitation, and other traditional pedagogical terms appear in the lexicon as ideal elements, but direct site references to these exact practices are limited. The presence of Trivium framing and rhetoric training aligns with Positive Keywords related to canonical pedagogy. - Negative keywords present: there is limited evidence of a pure “experience-based/project-based” pedagogy dominating the program (as identified in the Negative Keywords for this category). The site emphasizes structured classical pedagogy rather than a broad nontraditional approach.

Why this rating - The institution demonstrates many classical pedagogy markers (Trivium, rhetoric, structured home-school partnership, and formation), but explicit, repeated documentation of Socratic seminars, scholarly discourse formats, and Scholé-like contemplative days is not consistently presented in the public content. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Citations - University-Model pedagogy and home-school partnership: - Trivium-based curriculum and rhetoric: - Great books / historical-literary integration (pedagogical emphasis):

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials present named leaders (Head of School and two principal staff members) who articulate a faith-driven, formation-oriented approach, and who describe themselves as part of a founding-parent-led effort. This signals a school culture in which teachers model virtues and are central to the school's mission. - The site uses language around “founding parents,” “Head of School,” and “Director of School Programs and Planning” indicating a lived sense of community and mentorship among faculty. The faculty are described as aligned with the University-Model framework and classical aims, but explicit statements about a formal “living curriculum” or “portrait of a teacher” are not widely documented in the public text. - While the site emphasizes character formation and virtue through faculty modeling, there is less explicit

articulation of a formal faculty development philosophy that mirrors the classical “portrait of a teacher” or “living curriculum” in their public materials (as found in canonical classical sources).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: mentoring, virtue, character formation, teacher as model, formation through example, and collegial culture are aligned with Positive Keywords for the Faculty category (living curriculum, virtuous educators). Some of these ideas are present in biographical content and program descriptions. - Negative keywords present: the site does not consistently present a formalized “portrait of a teacher” or scholarly professional development framework in public materials, which is a stronger signal in some classical programs. The absence of explicit language around a formal faculty-cultivation framework keeps the category from a full CLASSICAL designation.

Why this rating - The presence of named leaders and a culture of virtue modeling supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The lack of explicit “living curriculum portrait” language or formal faculty formation documentation in public materials explains not giving a full CLASSICAL rating.

Citations - Head of School and faith-led leadership: - Founding-parent/administrative structure and programs:

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Harvest Academy explicitly emphasizes a strong Parent Partnership model in which parents are co-teachers and actively engaged partners in education. The school states that it partners with families, provides weekly lesson plans, and invites parent involvement in both on-campus and home-learning days. This aligns with the classical emphasis on family formation and home-school collaboration. - There are explicit mentions of parent information nights, enrollment processes that require parent involvement, and a focus on helping parents understand classical education principles and Christian worldview. This aligns with the Positive Keywords around parental partnership and community involvement. - The site demonstrates a strong community orientation, highlighting parent testimonials and a culture of community and mutual support among families, teachers, and staff (e.g., “We train and equip our students to become wise disciples of Jesus Christ” and parent testimonials).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: parent partnership, co-teachers, family involvement, home-school hybrid, parental formation, community support, open campus, hospitality, and living tradition in the family. These align with the Positive Keywords in the “Parental partnership” and “Family involvement” strands of the Six Essential Elements lexicon. - Negative keywords present: there is no strong signal of a consumer-oriented or minimal-parent involvement approach; the site consistently presents parents as central collaborators, which supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The pedagogical ownership by families, regular parental engagement, and explicit invitations for parent participation strongly align with classical models that treat parents as co-educators and integral to the school community.

Citations - Parent Partnership and co-teaching model: - Community and parent formation emphasis:

Synthesis and Aggregate Ranking

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate general assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Provide explicit, public documentation of Socratic seminars and disciplined, teacher-facilitated dialogue across grade bands, as well as explicit references to Schlöe-like contem-

plative learning days (e.g., “Scholé” rest periods). This would move Pedagogy from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL.

- Element 5 (Faculty): Public articulation of a formal “portrait of a teacher” and a more explicit living-curriculum framework for faculty development (structured professional growth in classical pedagogy, shared seminars for teachers, living-books seminars for faculty). This would strengthen the Faculty category to CLASSICAL.
- Element 4 and 5 together: Expand explicit references to memory-work/recitation, chanting, and liturgical rhythms in on-site and home-day activities, clarifying how these practices are integrated across grade levels as a sustained pedagogical pattern.
- Element 1–3, 6 are already CLASSICAL in their public materials. The school should maintain and deepen these signals by adding more explicit ritual and ritual-literature references (liturgical practices) and a consistent pedagogy with Socratic seminars to reach full CLASSICAL in Pedagogy and Faculty.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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